**Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version**

RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.
If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.
If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.
Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠Q

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣4

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠9

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣K

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦J

***Board 1***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A Q J 6 5 2<br>♥ K 8 2<br>♦ Q<br>♣ A 8 5 | |
| ♠ 10 4<br>♥ Q 9 4 3<br>♦ K J 5<br>♣ 10 6 4 2 |  | ♠ 8 7<br>♥ J 7 5<br>♦ 10 7 4 3<br>♣ Q J 7 3 |
| | ♠ K 9 3<br>♥ A 10 6<br>♦ A 9 8 6 2<br>♣ K 9 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1NT |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4♠ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♦[2] |
| Pass | 6♠ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

6♠ by North
Lead: ♣Q

When NORTH makes a slam try with a jump to 3♠, the best approach for SOUTH is to agree on the trump suit immediately but indicate a minimum hand by bidding 4♠.

NORTH's next move is logical; RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH shows zero or three Key Cards, and since it could not possibly be zero, NORTH knows they are the ♠K and both red Aces. Even possessing all the Key Cards NORTH knows there aren't enough points for a Grand slam.

***Board 2***
West Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 8 6 4 2<br>♥ 10 6<br>♦ J 9 6 2<br>♣ K J 4 | |
| ♠ 9 5<br>♥ A K 9 8 7 4 2<br>♦ 7 3<br>♣ 8 7 |  | ♠ A K<br>♥ Q J 3<br>♦ A K Q 5<br>♣ A 9 6 2 |
| | ♠ Q J 10 7 3<br>♥ 5<br>♦ 10 8 4<br>♣ Q 10 5 3 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass |
| 5♥[2] | Pass | 7NT | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

7NT by East
Lead: ♠Q

It is usually not recommended to use any form of Blackwood when you have a suit with two quick losers, but EAST knows WEST would not preempt with a 10-high ♥ suit.

WEST's reply to RKCB is 5♥, showing two Key Cards. EAST knows they are the ♥A ♥K so she can count thirteen tricks.

She bids a confident 7NT (and hopes WEST didn't open 3♥ with a 6-card suit.

***Board 3***
South Deals
E-W Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ J 9 6 4 3<br>♥ A Q 3<br>♦ Q 7<br>♣ Q 5 3 | |
| ♠ A 2<br>♥ 10 8 2<br>♦ J 9 4 2<br>♣ 10 6 4 2 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ K<br>♥ J 9 7 5 4<br>♦ 10 8 6 5<br>♣ 9 8 7 |
| | ♠ Q 10 8 7 5<br>♥ K 6<br>♦ A K 3<br>♣ A K J | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♠ |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♣[2] | Pass | 5♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♠ by South
Lead: ♣4

SOUTH has 21 points, and when she hears NORTH make a limit raise she tries for slam with RKCB.

NORTH answers with just one Key Card so SOUTH stops at 5♠, knowing they are missing two Key Cards.

Of course she didn't expect the two missing Key Cards to be the Ace and King of trumps!

***Board 4***
West Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 9 8 7<br>♥ 10 8 2<br>♦ J 8 2<br>♣ Q 10 7 3 | |
| ♠ A J 6<br>♥ K 7 5<br>♦ K Q 5 3<br>♣ A J 5 |  | ♠ K Q 5<br>♥ A Q 9 6<br>♦ 7 6 4<br>♣ K 9 6 |
| | ♠ 10 4 3 2<br>♥ J 4 3<br>♦ A 10 9<br>♣ 8 4 2 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1♦ | Pass | 1♥ | Pass |
| 2NT | Pass | 4NT | |
| All Pass | | | |

4NT by West
Lead: ♠9

What is this doing here in the RKCB Practice Pages?

To emphasize that there are many 4NT bids which are NOT asking for Aces.

In this case, WEST showed a balanced hand with 18 or 19 points, and EAST invited him to bid 6NT if he felt his hand was a "maximum". He didn't, so he passed.

***Board 5***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 5
♥ A K 9 7 6 2
♦ K 8
♣ 7 6 4

♠ J 10 4 3
♥ 10 4
♦ A 6
♣ Q J 9 5 3




♠ Q 8 6
♥ 8
♦ 10 9 4 2
♣ A K 10 8 2

♠ A 9 7 2
♥ Q J 5 3
♦ Q J 7 5 3
♣ —

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♥ | Pass | 4♣ |
| Pass | 4NT | Pass | 6♣ |
| Pass | 6♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣K

When SOUTH makes a Splinter bid, showing ♥ support and ♣ shortness, NORTH naturally thinks about slam.

She uses RKCB 4NT, and SOUTH, with one Key Card and a ♣ Void, bids 6♣.

Just what NORTH needed for the 6♥ bid.

***Board 6***
East Deals
E-W Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ J 10 5<br>♥ 7 6 3<br>♦ 3 2<br>♣ 10 9 8 6 3 | |
| ♠ A K 6 3<br>♥ K Q 10 4<br>♦ K Q 8 5<br>♣ 2 |  | ♠ Q 9 8 2<br>♥ A 9 5<br>♦ A 6 4<br>♣ K Q J |
| | ♠ 7 4<br>♥ J 8 2<br>♦ J 10 9 7<br>♣ A 7 5 4 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 1NT | Pass |
| 2♣ | Pass | 2♠ | Pass |
| 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♠[2] | Pass |
| 6♠ | | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by East
Lead: ♦J

WEST thinks they should be in slam, and uses Stayman to check for a 4-4 Major fit.

When EAST announces four ♠s WEST uses RKCB 4NT.

EAST's 5♠ bid shows two Key Cards plus the ♠Q.

This fills the holes in WEST's hand nicely, so she bids 6♠.